

Petal the Butterfly's First Flight

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Petal was a young butterfly. She had just come out of her chrysalis. Her wings were orange and black. They were soft and new. They shimmered in the sun. Petal sat on a milkweed leaf. She watched the other butterflies. They looped through the air. They danced over the flowers. Whee! Flip! Glide! Petal wanted to fly too. But her wings felt wobbly. What if she fell? What if she could not do it? Petal felt nervous. Her antennae quivered. "I am not ready," she whispered.



Her friend Cricket the cricket chirped nearby. Chirp chirp! "Why so still, Petal?" asked Cricket. "My wings are new," said Petal. "I am afraid to fly." Cricket rubbed his wings together. "Everyone's first flight is wobbly," he said. "I will cheer for every flap." "Flap and float, you can do it." "Flap and float, you can do it." Petal repeated it softly. "Flap and float, you can do it." It became her brave wingsong. "Flap and float, you can do it."



Petal stood on the edge of the leaf. She opened her wings wide. Flap. She lifted a tiny bit. Float. She landed back on the leaf. "I did a hop!" she cried. Cricket cheered. "Chirp chirp! Again!" Petal tried once more. Flap flap. Float float. This time she stayed in the air. She was flying! "Flap and float, you can do it!" she sang. The wind held her gently. The sun warmed her wings. Petal felt amazed. She felt free. She looped around the milkweed. Whee!



Can you flap like Petal? Open your arms wide like wings. Flap flap flap! Now float, nice and slow. Petal flew to the flower garden. She sipped nectar from a pink blossom. Sweet! She danced with the other butterflies. Loop, glide, twirl. Cricket chirped below. "Chirp chirp! Beautiful!" Petal waved her wings at him. She was not afraid anymore. Her new wings were wonderful.



When the sky turned orange, Petal felt tired. She landed on a soft leaf. Cricket snuggled in the grass below. "You flew beautifully," he chirped. "Thank you for cheering," whispered Petal. She folded her wings like a blanket. "Flap and float," she yawned. The leaf rocked gently. The night flowers opened. And Petal slept, dreaming of sky dances.

Moral: *Brave little tries can grow into beautiful flights.*

The End